PLAYBOOK · PART 3 · ONBOARDING

Onboarding Playbook

From the day an offer is accepted to the end of the first ninety days, so a new designer feels expected, useful and supported.

How to use it. Start it the day the offer is accepted. Share the relevant parts with the new joiner so they can see what is coming.

1. Before day one

WHAT	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
Welcome note from the manager and the team			
Equipment, accounts and access ready			
A buddy chosen and introduced			
First-week schedule shared in advance			
Reading and work to look at, kept light			
Paperwork and HR steps explained			

2. Day one

- [ ] Met at the door, in person or on video, by someone who expected them
- [ ] Workspace and tools working before they sit down
- [ ] Lunch or coffee with the team
- [ ] A short conversation about the first week and what matters most
- [ ] Nothing important left for them to chase

3. The first week

DAY	FOCUS	PEOPLE TO MEET	OUTCOME
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			

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4. The first ninety days

Days 1 to 30: Learn
The people, the product, the way we work. One small contribution.

Days 31 to 60: Contribute
Real work with support. What does good look like?

Days 61 to 90: Own
An area they lead. How we will know it is going well.

Write these with the new joiner in the first week, not for them. A plan they helped write is one they will follow.

5. Check-in prompts for the first month

- [ ] What is clearer than you expected, and what is less clear?
- [ ] Who have you not yet met who you should?
- [ ] What is getting in your way?
- [ ] What would help you do your best work here?
- [ ] What can I do differently as your manager?

6. Close the loop on hiring

At thirty days, ask: what did the hiring process promise that onboarding did not deliver? What would you tell the next person?

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